

Board of Trustees Retreat Minutes

Saturday, May 10, 2025

10:00 a.m.

Elma Timberland Library

119 N 1st St.

Elma, WA 98541

Toni Gwin, *President, Pacific County*

Brian Mittge, *President Elect, Lewis County*

Hal Blanton, *At-Large, Lewis County*

Mary Beth Harrington, *Thurston County*

Dustin Loup, *Grays Harbor County*

Vacant Position, *Mason County*

Vacant Position, *At-Large, Thurston County*

Present Board: Toni Gwin, Brian Mittge, Hal Blanton, Dustin Loup

Board Absent: Mary Beth Harrington

Present Staff: Cheryl Heywood, Andrea Heisel, Brenda Lane, Rose Enos-Weedmark; recorder

Timberland Regional Library (TRL) Working Session Minutes

- 1. Call to Order and Pledge of Allegiance** – Toni Gwin called the meeting to order at 10:00 a.m.
- 2. Overview of the Day** – Toni Gwin
- 3. Board Training – Jennifer Leach WSU Extension– 10:03 – 11:10**
 - True Colors Leadership/Personality Style Inventory
Introductions of attendees and self-discussions. True Colors background and in-depth personality traits.
Attendees worked alone and in groups completing the True Colors Leadership activities and discussion ensued.
- 4. Break 11:10 a.m. – 11:19 a.m.**
- 5. Board Training continued** – 11:20 a.m. – 12:15 p.m.
 - Listening for Meaning-Seek First to Understand
Attendees worked on listening activities and discussion ensued.
 - How to Handle Constituents or Patron Concerns
Facilitation tips and characteristics of difficult behaviors discussion.
Compassion in effective leadership and leading with your heart discussion.
- 6. Working Lunch** - 12:15 p.m. – 1:15 p.m.
 - Land Acknowledgement Statement – slight revision and request for approval on May 28, 2025, Board of Trustees meeting. (12:16-12:30 p.m.)
 - Collective Bargaining & Negotiations – discussions of when negotiations will begin and points on the process. Trustee Mittge requested information on CPI statistics, if available, on the five counties comparable to the Seattle CPI. (12:30-12:56 p.m.)
 - Safety Presentation – Susan Faubion (12:59-1:51 p.m.)
Provided in-depth statistics on TRL safety measures and disruptive patron engagement.
- 7. Retreat Topics August 16, 2025, McCleary Timberland Library** – topics that were not discussed were moved to the August Retreat.
 - Future Planning
 - Service Point Analysis from the Facilities Committee
 - IMLS Discussion
 - Video Games/teens in libraries
- 8. Adjournment at 2:00 p.m.**